بَابُ الْحَمَامَةِ الْمُطَوَّقَةِ

ابْنُ الْمُقَفَّعِ — كَلِيلَةُ وَدِمْنَةُ

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كلمات لتعلّمها أوّلاً

Words to learn first — top 25 most frequent unfamiliar lemmas (of 432 total in the chapter)

1.	جُرَذ	53×	rat *(noun)* •
2.	غُرَاب	33×	raven, crow *(noun)* •
3.	سُلَحْفَاة	25×	turtle; tortoise *(noun)* •
4.	ظَبْي	22×	gazelle, deer *(noun)* •
5.	ضَيْف	11×	guest *(noun)* •
6.	قَانِص	11×	hunter, one who catches *(noun)* •
7.	طَوَّقَ	10×	collared, wearing a necklace *(passive participle)* •
8.	صَيَّاد	10×	hunter *(noun)* •
9.	عَاقِل	9×	intelligent, wise, one with reason *(noun)* •
10.	حَبْل	8×	rope, cord *(noun)* •
11.	مَوَدَّة	7×	affection, love, friendliness *(noun)* •
12.	رَأَى	7×	I saw *(verb)* •
13.	إِخْوان	6×	brothers *(noun)*
14.	رَجا	6×	to hope *(verb)*
15.	خِلَّة	6×	friendship, intimate bond, defect *(noun)* •
16.	عَدَاوَة	6×	enmity, hostility, animosity *(noun)* •
17.	سِمْسِم	6×	sesame *(noun)* •
18.	شَبَكَة	5×	net; mesh *(noun)* •
19.	عَقْل	5×	mind, intellect, reason, understanding *(noun)* •
20.	جُحْرِي	5×	of or relating to a burrow *(adjective)* •
21.	ظَنَّ	5×	to think, suppose, conjecture *(verb)* •
22.	الْتَمَسَ	5×	to seek, request, ask for, touch *(v)* •
23.	قَشَرَ	5×	peeled, stripped, bare *(passive participle)* •
24.	مَنَعَ	4×	to prevent, withhold, deny, protect *(v)* •
25.	أَقْبَلَ	4×	to come forward, advance, approach *(verb)* •

• = not yet in your Alif vocabulary · in the body text, a saffron underline marks words introduced in this key; a faint gray underline marks other unfamiliar words to infer from context

قَالَ دَبْشَلِيمُ الْمَلِكُ لِبَيْدَبَا الْفَيْلَسُوفِ: قَدْ سَمِعْتُ مَثَلَ الْمُتَحَابَّيْنِ كَيْفَ قَطَعَ بَيْنَهُمَا الْكَذُوبُ وَإِلَى مَاذَا صَارَ عَاقِبَةُ أَمْرِهِ مِنْ بَعْدِ ذَلِكَ.

King Dabshalīm said to the philosopher Bidpai: I have heard the parable of the two loving friends — how the liar severed the bond between them, and to what end his affair came after that.

فَحَدِّثْنِي، إِنْ رَأَيْتَ؛ عَنْ إِخْوَانِ الصَّفَاءِ كَيْفَ يَبْتَدِئُ تَوَاصُلُهُمْ وَيَسْتَمْتِعُ بَعْضُهُمْ بِبَعْضٍ؟

So tell me, if you will: of the Brethren of Purity — how does their companionship begin, and how do they take delight in one another?

قَالَ الْفَيْلَسُوفُ: إِنَّ الْعَاقِلَ لَا يَعْدِلُ بِالْإِخْوَانِ شَيْئًا فَالْإِخْوَانُ هُمُ الْأَعْوَانُ عَلَى الْخَيْرِ كُلِّهِ، وَالْمُوَاسُونَ عِنْدَ مَا يَنُوبُ مِنَ الْمَكْرُوهِ.

The philosopher said: The wise man counts nothing equal to brethren; for brethren are one's helpmates in every good, and one's consolers when misfortune strikes.

وَمِنْ أَمْثَالِ ذَلِكَ مَثَلُ الْحَمَامَةِ الْمُطَوَّقَةِ وَالْجُرَذِ وَالظَّبْيِ وَالْغُرَابِ.

An instance of this is the fable of the Ring-Necked Dove, the Rat, the Gazelle, and the Crow.

قَالَ الْمَلِكُ: وَكَيْفَ كَانَ ذَلِكَ؟

The king said: And how was that?

قَالَ بَيْدَبَا: زَعَمُوا أَنَّهُ كَانَ بِأَرْضِ سَكَاوَنْدَجِينَ، عِنْدَ مَدِينَةِ دَاهِرَ، مَكَانٌ كَثِيرُ الصَّيْدِ، يَنْتَابُهُ الصَّيَّادُونَ؛ وَكَانَ فِي ذَلِكَ الْمَكَانِ شَجَرَةٌ كَثِيرَةُ الْأَغْصَانِ مُلْتَفَّةُ الْوَرَقِ فِيهَا وَكْرُ غُرَابٍ.

Bidpai said: They tell that in the land of Sakāwandajīn, near the city of Dāhar, there was a place abounding in game, often frequented by hunters; and in that place stood a tree of many branches with thick foliage, in which there was a crow's nest.

فَبَيْنَمَا هُوَ ذَاتَ يَوْمٍ سَاقِطٌ فِي وَكْرِهِ إِذْ بَصُرَ بِصَيَّادٍ قَبِيحِ الْمَنْظَرِ، سَيِّئِ الْخُلُقِ، عَلَى عَاتِقِهِ شَبَكَةٌ، وَفِي يَدِهِ عَصًا مُقْبِلًا نَحْوَ الشَّجَرَةِ، فَذُعِرَ مِنْهُ الْغُرَابُ؛ وَقَالَ: لَقَدْ سَاقَ هَذَا الرَّجُلَ إِلَى هَذَا الْمَكَانِ: إِمَّا حَيْنِي وَإِمَّا حَيْنُ غَيْرِي.

While the crow was one day perched in his nest, he caught sight of a hunter, foul of aspect and ill of temper, with a net on his shoulder and a staff in his hand, advancing toward the tree. The crow was terrified and said: This man has been driven here: either for my doom or for the doom of another.

I shall hold my place and watch what he does.

فَلَأُثْبِتَنَّ مَكَانِي حَتَّى أَنْظُرَ مَاذَا يَصْنَعُ.

Then the hunter spread his net, scattered grain upon it, and lay in ambush nearby. He had not waited long before a dove called the Ring-Necked passed by, the mistress of her flock and with her many other doves. She and her companions were blind to the snare, and they fell upon the grain to pick it up, and were all entangled in the net. The hunter came forward rejoicing.

ثُمَّ إِنَّ الصَّيَّادَ نَصَبَ شَبَكَتَهُ، وَنَثَرَ عَلَيْهَا الْحَبَّ، وَكَمَنَ قَرِيبًا مِنْهَا، فَلَمْ يَلْبَثْ إِلَّا قَلِيلًا، حَتَّى مَرَّتْ بِهِ حَمَامَةٌ يُقَالُ لَهَا الْمُطَوَّقَةُ، وَكَانَتْ سَيِّدَةَ الْحَمَامِ وَمَعَهَا حَمَامٌ كَثِيرٌ؛ فَعَمِيَتْ هِيَ وَصَوَاحِبُهَا عَنِ الشَّرَكِ، فَوَقَعْنَ عَلَى الْحَبِّ يَلْتَقِطْنَهُ فَعَلِقْنَ فِي الشَّبَكَةِ كُلُّهُنَّ؛ وَأَقْبَلَ الصَّيَّادُ فَرِحًا مَسْرُورًا.

Every dove began to thrash in her bonds, seeking deliverance for herself alone.

فَجَعَلَتْ كُلُّ حَمَامَةٍ تَضْطَرِبُ فِي حَبَائِلِهَا وَتَلْتَمِسُ الْخَلَاصَ لِنَفْسِهَا.

The Ring-Necked Dove said: Do not forsake one another in the struggle; let none of you hold her own self dearer than her sister's. Instead let us all join together and lift the net, so that each of us is saved through the others.

قَالَتِ الْمُطَوَّقَةُ: لَا تَخَاذَلْنَ فِي الْمُعَالَجَةِ وَلَا تَكُنْ نَفْسُ إِحْدَاكُنَّ أَهَمَّ إِلَيْهَا مِنْ نَفْسِ صَاحِبَتِهَا؛ وَلَكِنْ نَتَعَاوَنُ جَمِيعًا فَنَقْلَعُ الشَّبَكَةَ فَيَنْجُو بَعْضُنَا بِبَعْضٍ؛

So they all raised the net together by their cooperation and rose into the air. The hunter did not give up hope of them, thinking they would fly only a short way before falling again.

فَأَقْلَعْنَ الشَّبَكَةَ جَمِيعُهُنَّ بِتَعَاوُنِهِنَّ، وَعَلَوْنَ فِي الْجَوِّ؛ وَلَمْ يَقْطَعِ الصَّيَّادُ رَجَاءَهُ مِنْهُنَّ وَظَنَّ أَنَّهُنَّ لَا يُجَاوِزْنَ إِلَّا قَرِيبًا وَيَقَعْنَ.

The crow said to himself: I shall follow them and see what becomes of them.

فَقَالَ الْغُرَابُ: لَأَتْبَعَنَّهُنَّ وَأَنْظُرَ مَا يَكُونُ مِنْهُنَّ.

The Ring-Necked Dove turned her head and saw the hunter pursuing them.

فَالْتَفَتَتِ الْمُطَوَّقَةُ فَرَأَتِ الصَّيَّادَ يَتْبَعُهُنَّ.

فَقَالَتْ لِلْحَمَامِ: هَذَا الصَّيَّادُ مُجِدٌّ فِي طَلَبِكُنَّ، فَإِنْ نَحْنُ أَخَذْنَا فِي الْفَضَاءِ لَمْ يَخْفَ عَلَيْهِ أَمْرُنَا وَلَمْ يَزَلْ يَتْبَعُنَا وَإِنْ نَحْنُ تَوَجَّهْنَا إِلَى الْعُمْرَانِ خَفِيَ عَلَيْهِ أَمْرُنَا، وَانْصَرَفَ.

She said to the flock: This hunter is relentless in pursuit. If we fly into open country, he will keep us in sight and never leave off. But if we turn toward dwelling-places, he will lose sight of us and turn back.

وَبِمَكَانِ كَذَا جُرَذٌ هُوَ لِي أَخٌ؛ فَلَوِ انْتَهَيْنَا إِلَيْهِ قَطَعَ عَنَّا هَذَا الشَّرَكَ.

And in such-and-such a place there is a rat who is my brother; if we reach him, he will cut this snare from us.

فَفَعَلْنَ ذَلِكَ. وَأَيِسَ الصَّيَّادُ مِنْهُنَّ وَانْصَرَفَ. وَتَبِعَهُنَّ الْغُرَابُ.

So they did this. The hunter despaired of them and turned back. But the crow followed on after them.

فَلَمَّا انْتَهَتِ الْحَمَامَةُ الْمُطَوَّقَةُ إِلَى الْجُرَذِ، أَمَرَتِ الْحَمَامَ أَنْ يَسْقُطْنَ، فَوَقَعْنَ؛ وَكَانَ لِلْجُرَذِ مِائَةُ حَجَرٍ لِلْمَخَاوِفِ فَنَادَتْهُ الْمُطَوَّقَةُ بِاسْمِهِ، وَكَانَ اسْمُهُ زِيرَكَ، فَأَجَابَهَا الْجُرَذُ مِنْ حَجَرِهِ: مَنْ أَنْتِ؟

When the Ring-Necked Dove reached the rat, she ordered the doves to descend, and they alighted. The rat had a hundred holes for places of refuge. She called him by his name — his name was Zīrak — and the rat answered her from his hole: Who are you?

قَالَتْ: أَنَا خَلِيلَتُكَ الْمُطَوَّقَةُ.

She said: I am your dear friend, the Ring-Necked Dove.

فَأَقْبَلَ إِلَيْهَا الْجُرَذُ يَسْعَى، فَقَالَ لَهَا: مَا أَوْقَعَكِ فِي هَذِهِ الْوَرْطَةِ؟

The rat hastened to her and said: What has cast you into this plight?

قَالَتْ لَهُ: أَلَمْ تَعْلَمْ أَنَّهُ لَيْسَ مِنَ الْخَيْرِ وَالشَّرِّ شَيْءٌ إِلَّا هُوَ مُقَدَّرٌ عَلَى مَنْ تُصِيبُهُ الْمَقَادِيرُ، وَهِيَ الَّتِي أَوْقَعَتْنِي فِي هَذِهِ الْوَرْطَةِ؛ فَقَدْ لَا يَمْتَنِعُ مِنَ الْقَدَرِ مَنْ هُوَ أَقْوَى مِنِّي وَأَعْظَمُ أَمْرًا؛ وَقَدْ تَنْكَسِفُ الشَّمْسُ وَالْقَمَرُ إِذَا قُضِيَ ذَلِكَ عَلَيْهِمَا.

She said to him: Do you not know that nothing of good or evil befalls one but is decreed by fate, whom it touches? It is fate that has cast me into this plight. Stronger and mightier than I cannot escape destiny — even the sun and the moon suffer eclipse when this is decreed for them.

ثُمَّ إِنَّ الْجُرَذَ أَخَذَ فِي قَرْضِ الْعُقَدِ الَّذِي فِيهِ الْمُطَوَّقَةُ.

Then the rat set to gnawing the knot that held the Ring-Necked Dove.

فَقَالَتْ لَهُ الْمُطَوَّقَةُ: ابْدَأْ بِقَطْعِ عُقَدِ سَائِرِ الْحَمَامِ، وَبَعْدَ ذَلِكَ أَقْبِلْ عَلَى عُقْدِي؛ وَأَعَادَتْ ذَلِكَ عَلَيْهِ مِرَارًا، وَهُوَ لَا يَلْتَفِتُ إِلَى قَوْلِهَا، فَلَمَّا أَكْثَرَتْ عَلَيْهِ الْقَوْلَ وَكَرَّرَتْ، قَالَ لَهَا: لَقَدْ كَرَّرْتِ الْقَوْلَ عَلَيَّ كَأَنَّكِ لَيْسَ لَكِ فِي نَفْسِكِ حَاجَةٌ، وَلَا لَكِ عَلَيْهَا شَفَقَةٌ، وَلَا تَرْعَيْنَ لَهَا حَقًّا.

The Ring-Necked Dove said: Begin by cutting the knots of the other doves, then turn to my own. She said this to him again and again, but he paid no heed. When she had repeated it many times, he replied: You keep pressing me with this as if you cared nothing for your own self, had no pity on it, and paid it no due.

قَالَتْ: إِنِّي أَخَافُ، إِنْ أَنْتَ بَدَأْتَ بِقَطْعِ عُقْدِي أَنْ تَمَلَّ وَتَكْسَلَ عَنْ قَطْعِ مَا بَقِيَ؛ وَعَرَفْتُ أَنَّكَ إِنْ بَدَأْتَ بِهِنَّ قَبْلِي، وَكُنْتُ أَنَا الْأَخِيرَةَ لَمْ تَرْضَ وَإِنْ أَدْرَكَكَ الْفُتُورُ أَنْ أَبْقَى فِي الشَّرَكِ.

She said: I fear that if you begin with my knot, you will grow weary or slack before you finish the rest. But I know that if you begin with them and I am the last, even should weariness overtake you, you will not be content to leave me in the snare.

قَالَ الْجُرَذُ: هَذَا مِمَّا يَزِيدُ الرَّغْبَةَ وَالْمَوَدَّةَ فِيكِ.

The rat said: This only increases my desire and affection for you.

ثُمَّ إِنَّ الْجُرَذَ أَخَذَ فِي قَرْضِ الشَّبَكَةِ حَتَّى فَرَغَ مِنْهَا، فَانْطَلَقَتِ الْمُطَوَّقَةُ وَحَمَامُهَا مَعَهَا.

Then the rat set to gnawing the net until he had finished with it; and the Ring-Necked Dove went her way, her flock with her.

فَلَمَّا رَأَى الْغُرَابُ صُنْعَ الْجُرَذِ، رَغِبَ فِي مُصَادَقَتِهِ، فَجَاءَ وَنَادَاهُ بِاسْمِهِ، فَأَخْرَجَ الْجُرَذُ رَأْسَهُ، فَقَالَ لَهُ: مَا حَاجَتُكَ؟

When the crow saw what the rat had done, he desired his friendship. He came and called the rat by name. The rat thrust out his head and said: What do you want?

قَالَ: إِنِّي أُرِيدُ مُصَادَقَتَكَ.

The crow said: I wish to be your friend.

قَالَ الْجُرَذُ: لَيْسَ بَيْنِي وَبَيْنَكَ تَوَاصُلٌ، وَإِنَّمَا الْعَاقِلُ يَنْبَغِي لَهُ أَنْ يَلْتَمِسَ مَا يَجِدُ إِلَيْهِ سَبِيلًا، وَيَتْرُكَ الْتِمَاسَ مَا لَيْسَ إِلَيْهِ سَبِيلٌ، فَإِنَّمَا أَنْتَ الْآكِلُ، وَأَنَا طَعَامٌ لَكَ.

The rat said: There can be no fellowship between you and me. The wise man should seek only that to which a way lies open, and leave off seeking what is unattainable. You are the eater; I am food for you.

قَالَ الْغُرَابُ: إِنَّ أَكْلِي إِيَّاكَ، وَإِنْ كُنْتَ لِي طَعَامًا، مِمَّا لَا يُغْنِي عَنِّي شَيْئًا؛ وَإِنَّ مَوَدَّتَكَ آنَسُ لِي مِمَّا ذَكَرْتَ وَلَسْتُ بِحَقِيقٍ، إِذَا جِئْتُ أَطْلُبُ مَوَدَّتَكَ، أَنْ تَرُدَّنِي خَائِبًا.

The crow said: My eating you, even if you are food to me, would avail me nothing. Your affection is dearer to me than what you mention. It is not fitting, when I come seeking your friendship, that you should send me away empty.

فَإِنَّهُ قَدْ ظَهَرَ لِي مِنْكَ مِنْ حُسْنِ الْخُلُقِ مَا رَغَّبَنِي فِيكَ، وَإِنْ لَمْ تَكُنْ تَلْتَمِسُ إِظْهَارَ ذَلِكَ: فَإِنَّ الْعَاقِلَ لَا يَخْفَى فَضْلُهُ، وَإِنْ هُوَ أَخْفَاهُ؛ كَالْمِسْكِ الَّذِي يُكْتَمُ ثُمَّ لَا يَمْنَعُهُ ذَلِكَ مِنْ نَشْرِ الطِّيبِ وَالْأَرَجِ الْفَائِحِ.

I have seen in you such excellence of character as draws me to you, even if you do not try to show it; for the wise man's merit does not stay hidden, though he hide it — like musk that is kept concealed but cannot help spreading its sweet and pervading scent.

قَالَ الْجُرَذُ: إِنَّ أَشَدَّ الْعَدَاوَةِ عَدَاوَةُ الْجَوْهَرِ: وَهِيَ عَدَاوَتَانِ: مِنْهَا مَا هُوَ مُتَكَافِئٌ كَعَدَاوَةِ الْفِيلِ وَالْأَسَدِ.

The rat said: The fiercest enmity is enmity of nature, and it is of two kinds. One is equal in strength, like the enmity between the elephant and the lion.

فَإِنَّهُ رُبَّمَا قَتَلَ الْأَسَدُ الْفِيلَ أَوِ الْفِيلُ الْأَسَدَ، وَمِنْهَا مَا قُوَّتُهُ مِنْ أَحَدِ الْجَانِبَيْنِ عَلَى الْآخَرِ كَعَدَاوَةِ مَا بَيْنِي وَبَيْنَ السِّنَّوْرِ وَبَيْنِي وَبَيْنَكَ، فَإِنَّ الْعَدَاوَةَ الَّتِي بَيْنَنَا لَيْسَتْ تَضُرُّكَ، وَإِنَّمَا ضَرَرُهَا عَائِدٌ عَلَيَّ،

For sometimes the lion kills the elephant, or the elephant the lion. The other kind is one-sided in strength, like the enmity between me and the cat, or between me and you. The enmity between us does not harm you — its harm falls only upon me.

فَإِنَّ الْمَاءَ لَوْ أُطِيلَ إِسْخَانُهُ لَمْ يَمْنَعْهُ ذَلِكَ مِنْ إِطْفَائِهِ النَّارَ إِذَا صُبَّ عَلَيْهَا، وَإِنَّمَا مُصَاحِبُ الْعَدُوِّ وَمُصَالِحُهُ كَصَاحِبِ الْحَيَّةِ يَحْمِلُهَا فِي كُمِّهِ، وَالْعَاقِلُ لَا يَسْتَأْنِسُ إِلَى الْعَدُوِّ الْأَرِيبِ.

For though water be long heated, that does not stop it from putting out fire when poured upon it. The companion of an enemy, who makes terms with him, is like the one who carries a snake in his sleeve; and the wise man is not at ease with a cunning foe.

قَالَ الْغُرَابُ: قَدْ فَهِمْتُ مَا تَقُولُ، وَأَنْتَ خَلِيقٌ أَنْ تَأْخُذَ بِفَضْلِ خَلِيقَتِكَ، وَتَعْرِفَ صِدْقَ مَقَالَتِي وَلَا تُصَعِّبَ عَلَيَّ الْأَمْرَ بِقَوْلِكَ: لَيْسَ إِلَى التَّوَاصُلِ بَيْنَنَا سَبِيلٌ،

The crow said: I have understood what you say. You are of a nature to draw upon the excellence of your disposition and to recognize the sincerity of my speech — do not make things hard for me by saying there is no path to fellowship between us.

فَإِنَّ الْعُقَلَاءَ الْكِرَامَ لَا يَبْتَغُونَ عَلَى مَعْرُوفٍ جَزَاءً، وَالْمَوَدَّةُ بَيْنَ الصَّالِحِينَ سَرِيعٌ اتِّصَالُهَا بَطِيءٌ انْقِطَاعُهَا.

Wise and noble souls seek no reward for a kindness done. Affection among the virtuous is swift to form and slow to break.

وَمَثَلُ ذَلِكَ مَثَلُ الْكُوزِ مِنَ الذَّهَبِ: بَطِيءُ الِانْكِسَارِ، سَرِيعُ الْإِعَادَةِ، هَيِّنُ الْإِصْلَاحِ إِنْ أَصَابَهُ ثَلْمٌ أَوْ كَسْرٌ، وَالْمَوَدَّةُ بَيْنَ الْأَشْرَارِ سَرِيعٌ انْقِطَاعُهَا، بَطِيءٌ اتِّصَالُهَا.

It is like a vessel of gold: hard to break, quickly mended, easily restored if it should crack or shatter. But affection among the wicked is swift to break and slow to form.

وَمَثَلُ ذَلِكَ مَثَلُ الْكُوزِ مِنَ الْفَخَّارِ سَرِيعُ الِانْكِسَارِ يَنْكَسِرُ مِنْ أَدْنَى عَيْبٍ وَلَا وَصْلَ لَهُ أَبَدًا.

It is like a vessel of clay: quick to shatter, broken by the slightest flaw, and never to be joined again.

وَالْكَرِيمُ يَوَدُّ الْكَرِيمَ وَاللَّئِيمُ لَا يَوَدُّ أَحَدًا إِلَّا عَنْ رَغْبَةٍ أَوْ رَهْبَةٍ.

The noble love the noble; the base love no one save out of greed or fear.

وَأَنَا إِلَى وُدِّكَ وَمَعْرُوفِكَ مُحْتَاجٌ: لِأَنَّكَ كَرِيمٌ وَأَنَا مُلَازِمٌ لِبَابِكَ غَيْرُ ذَائِقٍ طَعَامًا حَتَّى تُؤَاخِيَنِي.

I am in need of your love and your favour, for you are noble; I shall stay at your door and taste no food until you take me as a brother.

قَالَ الْجُرَذُ: قَدْ قَبِلْتُ إِخَاءَكَ، فَإِنِّي لَمْ أَرُدَّ أَحَدًا عَنْ حَاجَةٍ قَطُّ، وَإِنَّمَا بَدَأْتُ بِمَا بَدَأْتُكَ بِهِ إِرَادَةَ التَّوَثُّقِ لِنَفْسِي فَإِنْ أَنْتَ غَدَرْتَ بِي لَمْ تَقُلْ: إِنِّي وَجَدْتُ الْجُرَذَ سَرِيعَ الِانْخِدَاعِ.

The rat said: I accept your brotherhood. I have never turned any away in need. I only began as I did to make sure of myself, so that if you betray me, you cannot say: I found the rat quick to be deceived.

ثُمَّ خَرَجَ مِنْ حَجَرِهِ، فَوَقَفَ عِنْدَ الْبَابِ.

Then he came out of his burrow and stood at the entrance.

فَقَالَ لَهُ الْغُرَابُ: مَا يَمْنَعُكَ مِنَ الْخُرُوجِ إِلَيَّ، وَالِاسْتِئْنَاسِ بِي؟ فَهَلْ فِي نَفْسِكَ بَعْدَ ذَلِكَ مِنِّي رِيبَةٌ؟

The crow said: What keeps you from coming out fully to me, from growing at ease with me? Do you still harbour any suspicion?

قَالَ الْجُرَذُ: إِنَّ أَهْلَ الدُّنْيَا يَتَعَاطَوْنَ فِيمَا بَيْنَهُمْ أَمْرَيْنِ وَيَتَوَاصَلُونَ عَلَيْهِمَا وَهُمَا ذَاتُ النَّفْسِ، وَذَاتُ الْيَدِ.

The rat said: The people of this world exchange two kinds of things with each other and form bonds upon them: the gifts of the self, and the gifts of the hand.

فَالْمُتَبَاذِلُونَ ذَاتَ النَّفْسِ هُمُ الْأَصْفِيَاءُ، وَأَمَّا الْمُتَبَاذِلُونَ ذَاتَ الْيَدِ فَهُمُ الْمُتَعَاوِنُونَ الَّذِينَ يَلْتَمِسُ بَعْضُهُمُ الِانْتِفَاعَ بِبَعْضٍ.

Those who exchange the gifts of the self are the true friends; those who exchange the gifts of the hand are the collaborators who seek profit from one another.

وَمَنْ كَانَ يَصْنَعُ الْمَعْرُوفَ لِبَعْضِ مَنَافِعِ الدُّنْيَا فَإِنَّمَا مَثَلُهُ فِيمَا يَبْذُلُ وَيُعْطِي كَمَثَلِ الصَّيَّادِ وَإِلْقَائِهِ الْحَبَّ لِلطَّيْرِ، لَا يُرِيدُ بِذَلِكَ نَفْعَ الطَّيْرِ وَإِنَّمَا يُرِيدُ نَفْعَ نَفْسِهِ.

Whoever does a good turn for some worldly gain is, in what he gives and spends, like the fowler who scatters grain for birds — he does not seek their good, but only his own.

فَتَعَاطِي ذَاتِ النَّفْسِ أَفْضَلُ مِنْ تَعَاطِي ذَاتِ الْيَدِ.

To exchange the gifts of the self is nobler than to exchange the gifts of the hand.

وَإِنِّي وَثِقْتُ مِنْكَ بِذَاتِ نَفْسِكَ، وَمَنَحْتُكَ مِنْ نَفْسِي مِثْلَ ذَلِكَ.

I have trusted in the gift of your self, and I have given you the same from mine.

وَلَيْسَ يَمْنَعُنِي مِنَ الْخُرُوجِ إِلَيْكَ سُوءُ ظَنٍّ بِكَ، وَلَكِنْ قَدْ عَرَفْتُ أَنَّ لَكَ أَصْحَابًا جَوْهَرُهُمْ كَجَوْهَرِكَ، وَلَيْسَ رَأْيُهُمْ فِيَّ رَأْيَكَ.

What holds me back from coming out to you is not any suspicion of you — but I know you have companions of the same kind as yourself, and their view of me is not yours.

قَالَ الْغُرَابُ: إِنَّ مِنْ عَلَامَةِ الصَّدِيقِ أَنْ يَكُونَ لِصَدِيقِ صَدِيقِهِ صَدِيقًا، وَلِعَدُوِّ صَدِيقِهِ عَدُوًّا؛ وَلَيْسَ لِي بِصَاحِبٍ وَلَا صَدِيقٍ مَنْ لَا يَكُونُ لَكَ مُحِبًّا؛ وَإِنَّهُ يَهُونُ عَنْ قَطِيعَةِ مَنْ كَانَ كَذَلِكَ مِنْ جَوْهَرِي.

The crow said: A mark of a friend is that he is friend to his friend's friend, and enemy to his friend's enemy. Any of my kind who does not love you is no companion, no friend of mine — and I would easily forsake such a one.

ثُمَّ إِنَّ الْجُرَذَ خَرَجَ إِلَى الْغُرَابِ فَتَصَافَحَا وَتَصَافَيَا، وَأَنِسَ كُلُّ وَاحِدٍ مِنْهُمَا بِصَاحِبِهِ؛

Then the rat came out to the crow. They greeted each other, grew intimate, and each found comfort in his companion.

حَتَّى إِذَا مَضَتْ لَهُمَا أَيَّامٌ قَالَ الْغُرَابُ لِلْجُرَذِ: إِنَّ جُحْرَكَ قَرِيبٌ مِنْ طَرِيقِ النَّاسِ، وَأَخَافُ أَنْ يَرْمِيَكَ بَعْضُ الصِّبْيَانِ بِحَجَرٍ؛

After some days had passed, the crow said to the rat: Your burrow is close to the road of men, and I fear some boy may throw a stone at you.

وَلِي مَكَانٌ فِي عُزْلَةٍ، وَلِي فِيهِ صَدِيقٌ مِنَ السَّلَاحِفِ وَهُوَ مُخْصِبٌ مِنَ السَّمَكِ وَنَحْنُ وَاجِدُونَ هُنَاكَ مَا نَأْكُلُ فَأُرِيدُ أَنْ أَنْطَلِقَ بِكَ إِلَى هُنَاكَ لِنَعِيشَ آمِنِينَ.

I have a place in a secluded spot where I have a friend among the tortoises, rich in fish. We shall find food there. I would take you with me so that we may live in safety.

قَالَ الْجُرَذُ: إِنَّ لِي أَخْبَارًا وَقِصَصًا سَأَقُصُّهَا عَلَيْكَ إِذَا انْتَهَيْنَا حَيْثُ تُرِيدُ فَافْعَلْ مَا تَشَاءُ.

The rat said: I have stories and tales I shall tell you when we reach the place. Do as you wish.

فَأَخَذَ الْغُرَابُ بِذَنَبِ الْجُرَذِ وَطَارَ بِهِ حَتَّى بَلَغَ بِهِ حَيْثُ أَرَادَ.

So the crow took the rat by the tail and flew with him to the place he wanted.

فَلَمَّا دَنَا مِنَ الْعَيْنِ الَّتِي فِيهَا السُّلَحْفَاةُ بَصُرَتِ السُّلَحْفَاةُ بِغُرَابٍ وَمَعَهُ جُرَذٌ فَذُعِرَتْ مِنْهُ وَلَمْ تَعْلَمْ أَنَّهُ صَاحِبُهَا، فَنَادَاهَا فَخَرَجَتْ إِلَيْهِ وَسَأَلَتْهُ مِنْ أَيْنَ أَقْبَلْتَ؟

When he drew near the spring where the tortoise lived, she caught sight of a crow carrying a rat and was alarmed, not recognizing it was her friend. He called to her; she came out and asked: From where have you come?

فَأَخْبَرَهَا بِقِصَّتِهِ حِينَ تَبِعَ الْحَمَامَ وَمَا كَانَ مِنْ أَمْرِهِ وَأَمْرِ الْجُرَذِ حَتَّى انْتَهَى إِلَيْهَا.

He told her the story — how he had followed the doves, and all that happened between himself and the rat, down to his coming to her.

فَلَمَّا سَمِعَتِ السُّلَحْفَاةُ شَأْنَ الْجُرَذِ عَجِبَتْ مِنْ عَقْلِهِ وَوَفَائِهِ وَرَحَّبَتْ بِهِ وَقَالَتْ لَهُ: مَا سَاقَكَ إِلَى هَذِهِ الْأَرْضِ؟

When the tortoise heard the rat's story, she marvelled at his wisdom and loyalty. She welcomed him and said: What has brought you to this land?

قَالَ الْغُرَابُ لِلْجُرَذِ: اقْصُصْ عَلَيَّ الْأَخْبَارَ الَّتِي زَعَمْتَ أَنَّكَ تُحَدِّثُنِي بِهَا فَأَخْبِرْنِي بِهَا مَعَ جَوَابِ مَا سَأَلَتِ السُّلَحْفَاةُ، فَإِنَّهَا عِنْدَكَ بِمَنْزِلَتِي،

The crow said to the rat: Tell me now the tales you promised, and join them to your answer for the tortoise — for she stands with you in the same place as I do.

فَبَدَأَ الْجُرَذُ وَقَالَ: كَانَ مَنْزِلِي أَوَّلَ أَمْرِي بِمَدِينَةِ مَارُوتَ فِي بَيْتِ رَجُلٍ نَاسِكٍ وَكَانَ خَالِيًا مِنَ الْأَهْلِ وَالْعِيَالِ،

The rat began: My dwelling, in the first of my days, was in the city of Mārūt, in the house of an ascetic who had neither family nor kin.

وَكَانَ يُؤْتَى فِي كُلِّ يَوْمٍ بِسَلَّةٍ مِنَ الطَّعَامِ فَيَأْكُلُ مِنْهَا حَاجَتَهُ وَيُعَلِّقُ الْبَاقِيَ،

Each day a basket of food would be brought to him; he would eat what he needed and hang up the rest.

وَكُنْتُ أَرْصُدُ النَّاسِكَ، حَتَّى يَخْرُجَ وَأَثِبَ إِلَى السَّلَّةِ، فَلَا أَدَعُ فِيهَا طَعَامًا إِلَّا أَكَلْتُهُ، وَأَرْمِي بِهِ إِلَى الْجُرْذَانِ.

I used to watch the ascetic until he would go out, then leap up to the basket and leave no food in it but would eat it or toss it to the other rats.

فَجَهَدَ النَّاسِكُ مِرَارًا أَنْ يُعَلِّقَ السَّلَّةَ مَكَانًا لَا أَنَالُهُ فَلَمْ يَقْدِرْ عَلَى ذَلِكَ،

The ascetic laboured many times to hang the basket in a place I could not reach, but he could not manage it.

حَتَّى نَزَلَ بِهِ ذَاتَ لَيْلَةٍ ضَيْفٌ فَأَكَلَا جَمِيعًا، ثُمَّ أَخَذَا فِي الْحَدِيثِ فَقَالَ النَّاسِكُ لِلضَّيْفِ: مِنْ أَيِّ أَرْضٍ أَقْبَلْتَ؟ وَأَيْنَ تُرِيدُ الْآنَ؟

Then one night a guest came to him. They ate together, and fell to talking. The ascetic said to the guest: From what land have you come, and where are you bound now?

وَكَانَ الرَّجُلُ قَدْ جَابَ الْآفَاقَ وَرَأَى عَجَائِبَ فَأَنْشَأَ يُحَدِّثُ النَّاسِكَ عَمَّا وَطِئَ مِنَ الْبِلَادِ، وَرَأَى مِنَ الْعَجَائِبِ،

The man had crossed many horizons and seen marvels, so he began to tell the ascetic of the lands he had trodden and the wonders he had seen.

وَجَعَلَ النَّاسِكُ خِلَالَ ذَلِكَ يُصَفِّقُ بِيَدَيْهِ لِيُنَفِّرَنِي عَنِ السَّلَّةِ، فَغَضِبَ الضَّيْفُ وَقَالَ: أَنَا أُحَدِّثُكَ وَأَنْتَ تَهْزَأُ بِحَدِيثِي! فَمَا حَمَلَكَ عَلَى أَنْ سَأَلْتَنِي؟

All the while the ascetic clapped his hands to drive me away from the basket. The guest grew angry and said: I am telling you my tale and you mock my speech! Why then did you ask me?

فَاعْتَذَرَ إِلَيْهِ النَّاسِكُ، وَقَالَ: إِنَّمَا أُصَفِّقُ بِيَدِي لِأُنَفِّرَ جُرَذًا قَدْ تَحَيَّرْتُ فِي أَمْرِهِ، وَلَسْتُ أَضَعُ فِي الْبَيْتِ شَيْئًا إِلَّا أَكَلَهُ،

The ascetic apologised and said: I clap my hands only to scare off a rat whose affairs have bewildered me. I cannot put anything in the house but he eats it.

فَقَالَ الضَّيْفُ: جُرَذٌ وَاحِدٌ يَفْعَلُ ذَلِكَ أَمْ جُرْذَانٌ كَثِيرَةٌ؟

The guest said: Is it one rat that does this, or many?

فَقَالَ النَّاسِكُ: فَمَا أَسْتَطِيعُ لَهُ حِيلَةً.

The ascetic said: I can devise no stratagem against him.

قَالَ الضَّيْفُ: لَقَدْ ذَكَّرْتَنِي قَوْلَ الَّذِي قَالَ: لِأَمْرٍ مَا بَاعَتْ هَذِهِ الْمَرْأَةُ سِمْسِمًا مَقْشُورًا بِغَيْرِ مَقْشُورٍ!

The guest said: You have reminded me of the one who said: For some reason this woman bartered husked sesame for unhusked!

قَالَ النَّاسِكُ: وَكَيْفَ كَانَ ذَلِكَ؟

The ascetic said: And how was that?

The guest said: Once I lodged with a man at such-and-such a place. We dined together, and a bed was laid out for me.

قَالَ الضَّيْفُ: نَزَلْتُ مَرَّةً عَلَى رَجُلٍ بِمَكَانِ كَذَا، فَتَعَشَّيْنَا، ثُمَّ فُرِشَ لِي.

The man turned in on his bed, and toward the end of the night I heard him say to his wife: I intend to invite a company tomorrow to eat with us; prepare food for them.

وَانْقَلَبَ الرَّجُلُ عَلَى فِرَاشِهِ، فَسَمِعْتُهُ يَقُولُ فِي آخِرِ اللَّيْلِ لِامْرَأَتِهِ: إِنِّي أُرِيدُ أَنْ أَدْعُوَ غَدًا رَهْطًا لِيَأْكُلُوا عِنْدَنَا، فَاصْنَعِي لَهُمْ طَعَامًا.

The woman said: How can you invite people to your food when there is nothing in your house beyond the needs of your own family? You are a man who keeps nothing in reserve.

فَقَالَتِ الْمَرْأَةُ: كَيْفَ تَدْعُو النَّاسَ إِلَى طَعَامِكَ، وَلَيْسَ فِي بَيْتِكَ فَضْلٌ عَنْ عِيَالِكَ؟ وَأَنْتَ رَجُلٌ لَا تُبْقِي شَيْئًا وَلَا تَدَّخِرُهُ.

The man said: Do not regret what we have fed and spent, for hoarding and storing may end as the wolf's end.

قَالَ الرَّجُلُ: لَا تَنْدَمِي عَلَى شَيْءٍ أَطْعَمْنَاهُ وَأَنْفَقْنَاهُ، فَإِنَّ الْجَمْعَ وَالِادِّخَارَ رُبَّمَا كَانَتْ عَاقِبَتُهُ كَعَاقِبَةِ الذِّئْبِ.

The woman said: And how was that?

قَالَتِ الْمَرْأَةُ وَكَيْفَ كَانَ ذَلِكَ؟

The man said: They tell that one day a hunter went out with his bow and arrows. He had not gone far before he shot a gazelle. He picked it up and turned back toward his house.

قَالَ الرَّجُلُ: زَعَمُوا أَنَّهُ خَرَجَ ذَاتَ يَوْمٍ رَجُلٌ قَانِصٌ، وَمَعَهُ قَوْسُهُ وَنَشَّابُهُ فَلَمْ يُجَاوِزْ غَيْرَ بَعِيدٍ، حَتَّى رَمَى ظَبْيًا، فَحَمَلَهُ وَرَجَعَ طَالِبًا مَنْزِلَهُ،

A wild boar crossed his path. He loosed an arrow that pierced it; but the boar reached him and struck him with its tusks a blow that sent the bow flying from his hand. Both fell dead.

فَاعْتَرَضَهُ خِنْزِيرٌ بَرِّيٌّ فَرَمَاهُ بِنَشَّابَةٍ نَفَذَتْ فِيهِ، فَأَدْرَكَهُ الْخِنْزِيرُ وَضَرَبَهُ بِأَنْيَابِهِ ضَرْبَةً أَطَارَتْ مِنْ يَدِهِ الْقَوْسَ، وَوَقَعَا مَيِّتَيْنِ،

A wolf came upon them and said: This man, the gazelle, and the boar will feed me for a long time. But I will begin with this bowstring and eat it for my day's ration.

فَأَتَى عَلَيْهِمْ ذِئْبٌ فَقَالَ: هَذَا الرَّجُلُ وَالظَّبْيُ وَالْخِنْزِيرُ يَكْفِينِي أَكْلُهُمْ مُدَّةً، وَلَكِنْ أَبْدَأُ بِهَذَا الْوَتَرِ فَآكُلُهُ، فَيَكُونُ قُوتَ يَوْمِي،

فَعَالَجَ الْوَتَرَ حَتَّى قَطَعَهُ فَلَمَّا انْقَطَعَ طَارَتْ سِيَةُ الْقَوْسِ فَضَرَبَتْ حَلْقَهُ فَمَاتَ.

He worked at the bowstring until he severed it. When it snapped, the curved tip of the bow flew up and struck his throat, and he died.

وَإِنَّمَا ضَرَبْتُ لَكِ هَذَا الْمَثَلَ لِتَعْلَمِي أَنَّ الْجَمْعَ وَالِادِّخَارَ وَخِيمُ الْعَاقِبَةِ.

I have told you this parable only so that you may know that hoarding and storing end in ruin.

فَقَالَتِ الْمَرْأَةُ: نِعْمَ مَا قُلْتَ! وَعِنْدَنَا مِنَ الْأَرُزِّ وَالسِّمْسِمِ مَا يَكْفِي سِتَّةَ نَفَرٍ أَوْ سَبْعَةً، فَأَنَا غَادِيَةٌ عَلَى اصْطِنَاعِ الطَّعَامِ، فَادْعُ مَنْ أَحْبَبْتَ.

The woman said: Well said! We have rice and sesame enough for six or seven — I shall set to preparing the meal in the morning; invite whom you will.

وَأَخَذَتِ الْمَرْأَةُ حِينَ أَصْبَحَتْ سِمْسِمًا فَقَشَّرَتْهُ، وَبَسَطَتْهُ فِي الشَّمْسِ لِيَجِفَّ، وَقَالَتْ لِغُلَامٍ لَهُمْ: اطْرُدْ عَنْهُ الطَّيْرَ وَالْكِلَابَ

In the morning the woman took some sesame, husked it, spread it out in the sun to dry, and said to their servant-boy: Keep the birds and dogs away from it.

وَتَفَرَّغَتِ الْمَرْأَةُ لِصُنْعِهَا؛ وَتَغَافَلَ الْغُلَامُ عَنِ السِّمْسِمِ؛ فَجَاءَ كَلْبٌ، فَعَاثَ فِيهِ؛ فَاسْتَقْذَرَتْهُ الْمَرْأَةُ، وَكَرِهَتْ أَنْ تَصْنَعَ مِنْهُ طَعَامًا مَا؛

The woman went to her cooking. The boy was careless about the sesame, and a dog came and fouled it. The woman found it unclean and would not make food from it.

فَذَهَبَتْ بِهِ إِلَى السُّوقِ، فَأَخَذَتْ بِهِ مُقَايَضَةً سِمْسِمًا غَيْرَ مَقْشُورٍ: مِثْلًا بِمِثْلٍ، وَأَنَا وَاقِفٌ فِي السُّوقِ؛

She took it to the market and bartered it, measure for measure, for unhusked sesame. I was standing in the market.

فَقَالَ رَجُلٌ: لِأَمْرٍ مَا بَاعَتْ هَذِهِ الْمَرْأَةُ سِمْسِمًا مَقْشُورًا بِغَيْرِ مَقْشُورٍ.

A man said: For some reason this woman has sold husked sesame for unhusked.

وَكَذَلِكَ قَوْلِي فِي هَذَا الْجُرَذِ الَّذِي ذَكَرْتَ أَنَّهُ عَلَى غَيْرِ عِلَّةٍ مَا يَقْدِرُ عَلَى مَا شَكَوْتَ مِنْهُ.

So too my saying about this rat whom you mention — he could not do what you complain of without some cause.

فَالْتَمِسْ لِي فَأْسًا لَعَلِّي أَحْتَفِرُ جُحْرَهُ فَأَطَّلِعَ عَلَى بَعْضِ شَأْنِهِ.

Bring me a mattock so that I may dig up his hole and see for myself something of his affairs.

فَاسْتَعَارَ النَّاسِكُ مِنْ بَعْضِ جِيرَانِهِ فَأْسًا، فَأَتَى بِهَا الضَّيْفَ، وَأَنَا حِينَئِذٍ فِي غَيْرِ جُحْرِي أَسْمَعُ كَلَامَهُمَا،

The ascetic borrowed a mattock from one of his neighbours and brought it to the guest. At that moment I was out of my burrow, listening to their talk.

وَفِي جُحْرِي كِيسٌ فِيهِ مِائَةُ دِينَارٍ، لَا أَدْرِي مَنْ وَضَعَهَا، فَاحْتَفَرَ الضَّيْفُ حَتَّى انْتَهَى إِلَى الدَّنَانِيرِ فَأَخَذَهَا

In my hole was a purse with a hundred dinars in it — I did not know who had placed them there. The guest dug down until he reached the coins and took them.

وَقَالَ النَّاسِكُ: مَا كَانَ هَذَا الْجُرَذُ يَقْوَى عَلَى الْوُثُوبِ حَيْثُ كَانَ يَثِبُ إِلَّا بِهَذِهِ الدَّنَانِيرِ: فَإِنَّ الْمَالَ جَعَلَ لَهُ قُوَّةً وَزِيَادَةً فِي الرَّأْيِ وَالتَّمَكُّنِ.

The ascetic said: This rat could not have leapt where he leapt save by these dinars — wealth has given him strength, added to his cunning, and fortified his place.

وَسَتَرَى بَعْدَ هَذَا أَنَّهُ لَا يَقْدِرُ عَلَى الْوُثُوبِ حَيْثُ كَانَ يَثِبُ.

You shall see hereafter that he can no longer leap where he once did.

فَلَمَّا كَانَ مِنَ الْغَدِ اجْتَمَعَ الْجُرْذَانُ الَّتِي كَانَتْ مَعِي فَقَالَتْ: قَدْ أَصَابَنَا الْجُوعُ، وَأَنْتَ رَجَاؤُنَا

The next day the rats who were with me gathered and said: Hunger has struck us, and you are our hope.

فَانْطَلَقْتُ وَمَعِي الْجُرْذَانُ إِلَى الْمَكَانِ الَّذِي كُنْتُ أَثِبُ مِنْهُ إِلَى السَّلَّةِ فَحَاوَلْتُ ذَلِكَ مِرَارًا: فَلَمْ أَقْدِرْ عَلَيْهِ

So I set off with the rats to the place from which I used to leap up to the basket, and I tried it again and again — but I could not do it.

فَاسْتَبَانَ لِلْجُرْذَانِ نَقْصُ حَالِي فَسَمِعْتُهُنَّ يَقُلْنَ: انْصَرِفْنَ عَنْهُ، وَلَا تَطْمَعْنَ فِيمَا عِنْدَهُ: فَإِنَّا نَرَى لَهُ حَالًا لَا نَحْسَبُهُ إِلَّا قَدِ احْتَاجَ مَعَهَا إِلَى مَنْ يَعُولُهُ.

The rats saw how my state had fallen, and I heard them saying: Leave him alone, do not covet what he has; his state is such that we think he himself must need one to support him.

They abandoned me, joined my enemies, shunned me, and took to slandering me in my absence before those who hated and envied me.

فَتَرَكْنَنِي، وَلَحِقْنَ بِأَعْدَائِي وَجَفَوْنِي، وَأَخَذْنَ فِي غِيبَتِي عِنْدَ مَنْ يُعَادِينِي وَيَحْسُدُنِي.

I said to myself: Brothers, helpers, and friends exist only by wealth.

فَقُلْتُ فِي نَفْسِي: مَا الْإِخْوَانُ وَلَا الْأَعْوَانُ وَلَا الْأَصْدِقَاءُ إِلَّا بِالْمَالِ

I saw that the man without means, whenever he wishes for something, is held back by want from attaining it — like the water left in valleys from winter rain: it runs to no river, flows to no place, and the ground drinks it up.

وَوَجَدْتُ مَنْ لَا مَالَ لَهُ، إِذَا أَرَادَ أَمْرًا قَعَدَ بِهِ الْعَدَمُ عَمَّا يُرِيدُهُ: كَالْمَاءِ الَّذِي يَبْقَى فِي الْأَوْدِيَةِ مِنْ مَطَرِ الشِّتَاءِ: لَا يَمُرُّ إِلَى نَهْرٍ وَلَا يَجْرِي إِلَى مَكَانٍ، فَتَشْرَبُهُ أَرْضُهُ.

I found that he who has no brethren has no kin; he who has no child leaves no remembrance; he who has no wealth has no wit — no portion in this world or the next.

وَوَجَدْتُ مَنْ لَا إِخْوَانَ لَهُ لَا أَهْلَ لَهُ، وَمَنْ لَا وَلَدَ لَهُ لَا ذِكْرَ لَهُ، وَمَنْ لَا مَالَ لَهُ لَا عَقْلَ لَهُ، وَلَا دُنْيَا وَلَا آخِرَةَ لَهُ؛

For when a man grows poor, his kinsmen and brethren cut him off. The tree that grows in salt flats, gnawed at from every side, is like the poor man in need of what is in other men's hands.

لِأَنَّ الرَّجُلَ إِذَا افْتَقَرَ قَطَعَهُ أَقَارِبُهُ وَإِخْوَانُهُ فَإِنَّ الشَّجَرَةَ النَّابِتَةَ فِي السِّبَاخِ، الْمَأْكُولَةَ مِنْ كُلِّ جَانِبٍ، كَحَالِ الْفَقِيرِ الْمُحْتَاجِ إِلَى مَا فِي أَيْدِي النَّاسِ.

I found that poverty is the head of every calamity, drawing every kind of hatred upon its bearer, and a wellspring of slander.

وَوَجَدْتُ الْفَقْرَ رَأْسَ كُلِّ بَلَاءٍ، وَجَالِبًا إِلَى صَاحِبِهِ كُلَّ مَقْتٍ، وَمَعْدِنَ النَّمِيمَةِ.

I found that when a man grows poor, those who once trusted him suspect him, and those who once thought well of him think ill — and if another sins, he becomes the object of blame.

وَوَجَدْتُ الرَّجُلَ إِذَا افْتَقَرَ اتَّهَمَهُ مَنْ كَانَ لَهُ مُؤْتَمَنًا، وَأَسَاءَ بِهِ الظَّنَّ مَنْ كَانَ يَظُنُّ فِيهِ حَسَنًا: فَإِنْ أَذْنَبَ غَيْرُهُ كَانَ هُوَ لِلتُّهْمَةِ مَوْضِعًا.

وَلَيْسَ مِنْ خَلَّةٍ هِيَ لِلْغَنِيِّ مَدْحٌ إِلَّا وَهِيَ لِلْفَقِيرِ ذَمٌّ، فَإِنْ كَانَ شُجَاعًا قِيلَ: أَهْوَجُ، وَإِنْ كَانَ جَوَادًا سُمِّيَ مُبَذِّرًا، وَإِنْ كَانَ حَلِيمًا سُمِّيَ ضَعِيفًا، وَإِنْ كَانَ وَقُورًا سُمِّيَ بَلِيدًا.

There is no trait that is praise in the rich man which is not blame in the poor. If he is brave, they call him reckless; if generous, a spendthrift; if forbearing, weak; if grave, dull.

فَالْمَوْتُ أَهْوَنُ مِنَ الْحَاجَةِ الَّتِي تُحْوِجُ صَاحِبَهَا إِلَى الْمَسْأَلَةِ، وَلَا سِيَّمَا مَسْأَلَةِ الْأَشِحَّاءِ وَاللِّئَامِ:

Death is lighter than the need that drives its bearer to ask — above all, to ask of the stingy and the base.

فَإِنَّ الْكَرِيمَ لَوْ كُلِّفَ أَنْ يُدْخِلَ يَدَهُ فِي فَمِ الْأَفْعَى، فَيُخْرِجَ مِنْهُ سَمًّا فَيَبْتَلِعَهُ كَانَ ذَلِكَ أَهْوَنَ عَلَيْهِ وَأَحَبَّ إِلَيْهِ مِنْ مَسْأَلَةِ الْبَخِيلِ اللَّئِيمِ.

The noble man, if compelled to put his hand in a viper's mouth and draw forth venom to swallow, would find it easier and more welcome than to beg from the base miser.

وَقَدْ كُنْتُ رَأَيْتُ الضَّيْفَ حِينَ أَخَذَ الدَّنَانِيرَ فَقَاسَمَهَا النَّاسِكَ، فَجَعَلَ النَّاسِكُ نَصِيبَهُ فِي خَرِيطَةٍ عِنْدَ رَأْسِهِ

I had seen the guest, when he took the dinars, divide them with the ascetic. The ascetic put his share in a leather pouch beside his head.

وَلَمَّا جَنَّ اللَّيْلُ، فَطَمِعْتُ أَنْ أُصِيبَ مِنْهَا شَيْئًا فَأَرُدَّهُ إِلَى جُحْرِي، وَرَجَوْتُ أَنْ يَزِيدَ ذَلِكَ فِي قُوَّتِي، وَيُرَاجِعَنِي بِسَبَبِهِ بَعْضُ أَصْدِقَائِي.

When night fell dark, I coveted some of them to carry back to my hole — hoping this would restore my strength, and that some of my friends would come back to me because of it.

فَانْطَلَقْتُ إِلَى النَّاسِكِ وَهُوَ نَائِمٌ، حَتَّى انْتَهَيْتُ عِنْدَ رَأْسِهِ، وَوَجَدْتُ الضَّيْفَ يَقْظَانَ، وَبِيَدِهِ قَضِيبٌ، فَضَرَبَنِي عَلَى رَأْسِي ضَرْبَةً مُوجِعَةً، فَسَعَيْتُ إِلَى جُحْرِي.

So I crept up to the sleeping ascetic, until I was near his head — and found the guest wide awake, with a rod in his hand. He struck me on the head a painful blow, and I scurried back to my hole.

فَلَمَّا سَكَنَ عَنِّي الْأَلَمُ، هَيَّجَنِي الْحِرْصُ وَالشَّرَهُ، فَخَرَجْتُ طَمَعًا كَطَمَعِي الْأَوَّلِ، وَإِذَا الضَّيْفُ يَرْصُدُنِي، فَضَرَبَنِي ضَرْبَةً أَسَالَتْ مِنِّي الدَّمَ، فَتَقَلَّبْتُ ظَهْرًا لِبَطْنٍ إِلَى جُحْرِي، فَخَرَرْتُ مَغْشِيًّا عَلَيَّ،

When the pain subsided, greed and gluttony stirred me, and I went out again with the same desire. There was the guest lying in wait; he struck me a blow that drew my blood. I rolled over on my back toward my burrow and fell in a swoon.

فَأَصَابَنِي مِنَ الْوَجَعِ مَا أَبْغَضَ إِلَيَّ الْمَالَ رَعْدَةً وَهَيْبَةً.

So much pain befell me that I came to loathe wealth — a trembling dread of it seized me.

ثُمَّ تَذَكَّرْتُ فَوَجَدْتُ الْبَلَاءَ فِي الدُّنْيَا إِنَّمَا يَسُوقُهُ الْحِرْصُ وَالشَّرَهُ، وَلَا يَزَالُ صَاحِبُ الدُّنْيَا فِي بَلِيَّةٍ وَتَعَبٍ وَنَصَبٍ،

Then I reflected, and found that affliction in this world is driven by greed and gluttony. The worldly man is never free of calamity, toil, and weariness.

وَوَجَدْتُ تَجَشُّمَ الْأَسْفَارِ الْبَعِيدَةِ فِي طَلَبِ الدُّنْيَا أَهْوَنَ عَلَيَّ مِنْ بَسْطِ الْيَدِ إِلَى السَّخِيِّ بِالْمَالِ، وَلَمْ أَرَ كَالرِّضَا شَيْئًا،

I found that the toil of far journeys in quest of this world was lighter to me than stretching out a hand even to the generous for money — and I saw nothing equal to contentment.

فَصَارَ أَمْرِي إِلَى أَنْ رَضِيتُ وَقَنَعْتُ، وَانْتَقَلْتُ مِنْ بَيْتِ النَّاسِكِ إِلَى الْبَرِّيَّةِ، وَكَانَ لِي صَدِيقٌ مِنَ الْحَمَامِ، فَسِيقَتْ إِلَيَّ بِصَدَاقَتِهِ صَدَاقَةٌ.

So my affair came to this: I accepted, I was content, and I moved from the ascetic's house to the wilderness. I had a friend among the doves, and through her friendship another friendship was brought to me.

ثُمَّ ذَكَرَ لِي الْغُرَابُ مَا بَيْنَكِ وَبَيْنَهُ مِنَ الْمَوَدَّةِ، وَأَخْبَرَنِي أَنَّهُ يُرِيدُ إِتْيَانَكِ، فَأَحْبَبْتُ أَنْ آتِيَكِ مَعَهُ، فَكَرِهْتُ الْوَحْدَةَ،

Then the crow told me of the affection between you and him, and said he wished to come to you. I desired to come with him, for I have come to hate loneliness.

فَإِنَّهُ لَا شَيْءَ مِنْ سُرُورِ الدُّنْيَا يَعْدِلُ صُحْبَةَ الْإِخْوَانِ، وَلَا غَمَّ فِيهَا يَعْدِلُ الْبُعْدَ عَنْهُمْ.

There is no joy in the world equal to the company of brothers, and no sorrow in it equal to being apart from them.

وَجَرَّبْتُ فَعَلِمْتُ أَنَّهُ لَا يَنْبَغِي لِلْعَاقِلِ أَنْ يَلْتَمِسَ مِنَ الدُّنْيَا غَيْرَ الْكَفَافِ الَّذِي يَدْفَعُ بِهِ الْأَذَى عَنْ نَفْسِهِ، وَهُوَ الْيَسِيرُ مِنَ الْمَطْعَمِ وَالْمَشْرَبِ، إِذَا اشْتَمَلَ عَلَى صِحَّةِ الْبَدَنِ وَرَفَاهَةِ الْبَالِ.

I have tried and I have learned: the wise man should seek of this world no more than sufficiency — enough to keep harm from himself — a little food and drink, provided that it brings health of body and ease of mind.

وَلَوْ أَنَّ رَجُلًا وُهِبَتْ لَهُ الدُّنْيَا بِمَا فِيهَا لَمْ يَكُ يَنْتَفِعُ مِنْ ذَلِكَ إِلَّا بِالْقَلِيلِ الَّذِي يَدْفَعُ بِهِ عَنْ نَفْسِهِ الْحَاجَةَ:

If a man were given the world and all that is in it, he could profit by it only in the little that wards off his own need.

فَأَقْبَلْتُ مَعَ الْغُرَابِ إِلَيْكِ عَلَى هَذَا الرَّأْيِ، وَأَنَا لَكِ أَخٌ، فَلْتَكُنْ مَنْزِلَتِي عِنْدَكِ كَذَلِكَ.

With this conviction I have come with the crow to you. I am your brother — let my standing with you be so.

فَلَمَّا فَرَغَ الْجُرَذُ مِنْ كَلَامِهِ أَجَابَتْهُ السُّلَحْفَاةُ بِكَلَامٍ رَقِيقٍ عَذْبٍ، وَقَالَتْ: قَدْ سَمِعْتُ كَلَامَكَ، وَمَا أَحْسَنَ مَا تَحَدَّثْتَ بِهِ!

When the rat finished his words, the tortoise answered him with gentle, kindly speech and said: I have heard your words — how lovely is what you have told!

إِلَّا أَنِّي رَأَيْتُكَ تَذْكُرُ بَقَايَا أُمُورٍ هِيَ فِي نَفْسِكَ.

Yet I see that you still bring up remnants of matters that linger in your mind.

وَاعْلَمْ أَنَّ حُسْنَ الْكَلَامِ لَا يَتِمُّ إِلَّا بِحُسْنِ الْعَمَلِ، وَأَنَّ الْمَرِيضَ الَّذِي قَدْ عَلِمَ دَوَاءَ مَرَضِهِ إِنْ لَمْ يَتَدَاوَ بِهِ، لَمْ يُغْنِ بِهِ شَيْئًا، وَلَمْ يَجِدْ لِدَائِهِ رَاحَةً وَلَا خِفَّةً.

Know that fair speech is perfected only by fair deeds. The sick man who knows the remedy of his ailment, if he does not apply it, gains nothing by it and finds no relief or lightening of his disease.

فَاسْتَعْمِلْ رَأْيَكَ، وَلَا تَحْزَنْ لِقِلَّةِ الْمَالِ.

So act on your own counsel, and do not grieve at want of wealth.

فَإِنَّ الرَّجُلَ ذَا الْمُرُوءَةِ قَدْ يُكْرَمُ عَلَى غَيْرِ مَالٍ.

The man of honour may be held in esteem without wealth —

كَالْأَسَدِ الَّذِي يُهَابُ، وَإِنْ كَانَ رَابِضًا، وَالْغَنِيُّ الَّذِي لَا مُرُوءَةَ لَهُ يُهَانُ وَإِنْ كَانَ كَثِيرَ الْمَالِ كَالْكَلْبِ لَا يُحْفَلُ بِهِ، وَإِنْ طُوِّقَ وَخُلْخِلَ بِالذَّهَبِ.

like the lion, who is feared even as he lies at rest. The rich man without honour is despised however great his wealth — like a dog that none heeds, even if he be collared and anklets of gold hung upon him.

فَلَا تَكْبُرَنَّ عَلَيْكَ غُرْبَتُكَ: فَإِنَّ الْعَاقِلَ لَا غُرْبَةَ لَهُ: كَالْأَسَدِ الَّذِي لَا يَنْقَلِبُ إِلَّا وَمَعَهُ قُوَّتُهُ.

Do not let your being a stranger weigh upon you. The wise man is nowhere a stranger — he is like the lion, who does not move but his strength moves with him.

فَلْتُحْسِنْ تَعَاهُدَكَ لِنَفْسِكَ؛ فَإِنَّكَ إِذَا فَعَلْتَ ذَلِكَ جَاءَكَ الْخَيْرُ يَطْلُبُكَ كَمَا يَطْلُبُ الْمَاءُ انْحِدَارَهُ.

Tend well to yourself; and if you do, good will come seeking you as water seeks its downward course.

وَإِنَّمَا جُعِلَ الْفَضْلُ لِلْحَازِمِ الْبَصِيرِ بِالْأُمُورِ، وَأَمَّا الْكَسْلَانُ الْمُتَرَدِّدُ فَإِنَّ الْفَضْلَ لَا يَصْحَبُهُ.

Excellence is given to the resolute, the clear-sighted in affairs; as for the sluggish waverer, excellence does not keep his company.

وَقَدْ قِيلَ فِي أَشْيَاءَ لَيْسَ لَهَا ثَبَاتٌ وَلَا بَقَاءٌ: ظِلُّ الْغَمَامَةِ فِي الصَّيْفِ، وَخُلَّةُ الْأَشْرَارِ، وَالْبِنَاءُ عَلَى غَيْرِ أَسَاسٍ، وَالْمَالُ الْكَثِيرُ.

It has been said of things that have neither stability nor lasting: the shadow of a cloud in summer, the friendship of the wicked, a building without foundation, and great wealth.

فَالْعَاقِلُ لَا يَحْزَنُ لِقِلَّتِهِ، وَإِنَّمَا مَالُ الْعَاقِلِ عَقْلُهُ، وَمَا قَدَّمَ مِنْ صَالِحٍ،

So the wise man does not grieve at its scarcity. The wise man's wealth is his wisdom, and whatever good he has sent before him.

فَهُوَ وَاثِقٌ بِأَنَّهُ لَا يُسْلَبُ مَا عَمِلَ وَلَا يُؤَاخَذُ بِشَيْءٍ لَمْ يَعْمَلْهُ، وَهُوَ خَلِيقٌ أَلَّا يَغْفُلَ عَنْ أَمْرِ آخِرَتِهِ، فَإِنَّ الْمَوْتَ لَا يَأْتِي إِلَّا بَغْتَةً، لَيْسَ لَهُ وَقْتٌ مُعَيَّنٌ.

He is confident that what he has done shall not be stripped from him, nor shall he be held to account for what he has not done; and he is bound not to neglect the matter of his hereafter — for death comes only by surprise, having no appointed hour.

وَأَنْتَ عَنْ مَوْعِظَتِي غَنِيٌّ بِمَا عِنْدَكَ مِنَ الْعِلْمِ. وَلَكِنْ رَأَيْتُ أَنْ أَقْضِيَ مَا لَكَ مِنْ حَقٍّ قِبَلَنَا. لِأَنَّكَ أَخُونَا وَمَا عِنْدَنَا مِنَ النُّصْحِ مَبْذُولٌ لَكَ.

You have no need of my admonition, with the knowledge you possess — yet I thought to fulfill the due that is owed you from us, for you are our brother, and whatever counsel we have is freely yours.

فَلَمَّا سَمِعَ الْغُرَابُ كَلَامَ السُّلَحْفَاةِ لِلْجُرَذِ وَرَدَّهَا عَلَيْهِ وَمُلَاطَفَتَهَا إِيَّاهُ فَرِحَ بِذَلِكَ

When the crow heard the tortoise's words to the rat, her answer and her gentleness toward him, he rejoiced.

وَقَالَ: لَقَدْ سَرَرْتِنِي وَأَنْعَمْتِ عَلَيَّ، وَأَنْتِ جَدِيرَةٌ أَنْ تَسُرِّي نَفْسَكِ بِمِثْلِ مَا سَرَرْتِنِي بِهِ.

He said: You have pleased me and done well by me — you are worthy to please your own self with the like of what you have pleased me with.

وَإِنَّ أَوْلَى أَهْلِ الدُّنْيَا بِشِدَّةِ السُّرُورِ مَنْ لَا يَزَالُ عِنْدَهُ مِنْهُمْ جَمَاعَةٌ يَسُرُّهُمْ وَيَسُرُّونَهُ، وَيَكُونُ مِنْ وَرَاءِ أُمُورِهِمْ وَحَاجَاتِهِمْ بِالْمِرْصَادِ،

The most deserving of great joy among the people of this world is one who keeps ever at his side a company whom he gladdens and who gladden him, and who stands at the ready behind their affairs and their needs.

فَإِنَّ الْكَرِيمَ إِذَا عَثَرَ لَا يَأْخُذُ بِيَدِهِ إِلَّا الْكِرَامُ؛ كَالْفِيلِ إِذَا وَحِلَ لَا تُخْرِجُهُ إِلَّا الْفِيَلَةُ.

For when the noble man stumbles, only the noble lift him up — as the elephant mired in mud is pulled out only by elephants.

فَبَيْنَمَا الْغُرَابُ فِي كَلَامِهِ، إِذْ أَقْبَلَ نَحْوَهُمْ ظَبْيٌ يَسْعَى، فَذُعِرَتْ مِنْهُ السُّلَحْفَاةُ، فَغَاصَتْ فِي الْمَاءِ، وَخَرَجَ الْجُرَذُ إِلَى جُحْرِهِ، وَطَارَ الْغُرَابُ فَوَقَعَ عَلَى شَجَرَةٍ.

While the crow was still speaking, a gazelle came bounding toward them. The tortoise was startled and plunged into the water; the rat slipped into his hole; the crow took wing and settled on a tree.

ثُمَّ إِنَّ الْغُرَابَ حَلَّقَ فِي السَّمَاءِ لِيَنْظُرَ هَلْ لِلظَّبْيِ طَالِبٌ؟ فَنَظَرَ فَلَمْ يَرَ شَيْئًا؛

Then the crow circled high in the sky to see whether anyone was pursuing the gazelle; he looked and saw nothing.

فَنَادَى الْجُرَذَ وَالسُّلَحْفَاةَ، وَخَرَجَا،

He called to the rat and the tortoise, and they came out.

فَقَالَتِ السُّلَحْفَاةُ لِلظَّبْيِ، حِينَ رَأَتْهُ يَنْظُرُ إِلَى الْمَاءِ: اشْرَبْ إِنْ كَانَ بِكَ عَطَشٌ، وَلَا تَخَفْ، فَإِنَّهُ لَا خَوْفَ عَلَيْكَ.

The tortoise said to the gazelle, when she saw him gazing at the water: Drink if you are thirsty, and do not fear — no harm threatens you here.

فَدَنَا الظَّبْيُ فَرَحَّبَتْ بِهِ السُّلَحْفَاةُ وَحَيَّتْهُ وَقَالَتْ لَهُ: مِنْ أَيْنَ أَقْبَلْتَ؟

The gazelle came near. The tortoise welcomed him, greeted him, and said: From where have you come?

قَالَ: كُنْتُ أَسْنَحُ بِهَذِهِ الصَّحَارَى فَلَمْ تَزَلِ الْأَسَاوِرَةُ تَطْرُدُنِي مِنْ مَكَانٍ إِلَى مَكَانٍ حَتَّى رَأَيْتُ الْيَوْمَ شَبَحًا. فَخِفْتُ أَنْ يَكُونَ قَانِصًا

He said: I was roaming these wildernesses, but horsemen kept driving me from place to place, until today I glimpsed a figure. I feared it was a hunter.

قَالَتْ: لَا تَخَفْ، فَإِنَّا لَمْ نَرَ هَاهُنَا قَانِصًا قَطُّ، وَنَحْنُ نَبْذُلُ لَكَ وُدَّنَا وَمَكَانَنَا وَالْمَاءُ وَالْمَرْعَى كَثِيرَانِ عِنْدَنَا فَارْغَبْ فِي صُحْبَتِنَا.

She said: Do not be afraid — we have never seen a hunter here. We offer you our friendship and our place; water and pasture are plentiful with us. Join our company.

فَأَقَامَ الظَّبْيُ مَعَهُمْ وَكَانَ لَهُمْ عَرِيشٌ يَجْتَمِعُونَ فِيهِ وَيَتَذَاكَرُونَ الْأَحَادِيثَ وَالْأَخْبَارَ.

So the gazelle stayed with them. They had a bower in which they would gather and recount stories and news.

فَبَيْنَمَا الْغُرَابُ وَالْجُرَذُ وَالسُّلَحْفَاةُ ذَاتَ يَوْمٍ فِي الْعَرِيشِ غَابَ الظَّبْيُ فَتَوَقَّعُوهُ سَاعَةً فَلَمْ يَأْتِ.

One day, while the crow, the rat, and the tortoise were in the bower, the gazelle was missing. They waited a while, but he did not come.

فَلَمَّا أَبْطَأَ أَشْفَقُوا أَنْ يَكُونَ قَدْ أَصَابَهُ عَنَتٌ، فَقَالَ الْجُرَذُ وَالسُّلَحْفَاةُ لِلْغُرَابِ: انْظُرْ هَلْ تَرَى مِمَّا يَلِينَا شَيْئًا؟

As his delay lengthened they feared that harm had befallen him. The rat and the tortoise said to the crow: Look and see — do you see anything around us?

فَحَلَّقَ الْغُرَابُ فِي السَّمَاءِ فَنَظَرَ: فَإِذَا الظَّبْيُ فِي الْحَبَائِلِ مُقْتَنَصًا فَانْقَضَّ مُسْرِعًا فَأَخْبَرَهُمَا بِذَلِكَ

The crow circled on high and looked — and there was the gazelle, snared in the toils. He swooped down swiftly and told them.

فَقَالَتِ السُّلَحْفَاةُ وَالْغُرَابُ لِلْجُرَذِ: هَذَا أَمْرٌ لَا يُرْجَى فِيهِ غَيْرُكَ، فَأَغِثْ أَخَاكَ،

The tortoise and the crow said to the rat: No one but you can help here — go succour your brother.

فَسَعَى الْجُرَذُ مُسْرِعًا، فَأَتَى الظَّبْيَ، فَقَالَ لَهُ: كَيْفَ وَقَعْتَ فِي هَذِهِ الْوَرْطَةِ وَأَنْتَ مِنَ الْأَكْيَاسِ؟

The rat hurried off swiftly and came to the gazelle. He said to him: How have you fallen into this plight, when you are one of the clever ones?

قَالَ الظَّبْيُ: هَلْ يُغْنِي الْكَيْسُ مَعَ الْمَقَادِيرِ شَيْئًا،

The gazelle said: What good does cleverness avail against destiny?

فَبَيْنَمَا هُمَا فِي الْحَدِيثِ إِذْ وَافَتْهُمَا السُّلَحْفَاةُ فَقَالَ لَهَا الظَّبْيُ. مَا أَصَبْتِ بِمَجِيئِكِ إِلَيْنَا:

While they were talking, the tortoise came up to them. The gazelle said to her: You have done ill to come to us.

فَإِنَّ الْقَانِصَ لَوِ انْتَهَى إِلَيْنَا وَقَدْ قَطَعَ الْجُرَذُ الْحَبَائِلَ اسْتَبَقَهُ عَدْوًا، وَلِلْجُرَذِ أَحْجَارٌ كَثِيرَةٌ، وَالْغُرَابُ يَطِيرُ وَأَنْتِ ثَقِيلَةٌ لَا سَعْيَ لَكِ وَلَا حَرَكَةَ وَأَخَافُ عَلَيْكِ الْقَانِصَ.

For if the hunter reaches us after the rat has cut the snares, I can outrun him, the rat has many holes, and the crow can fly — but you are heavy, without swiftness, without motion, and I fear the hunter for you.

فَقَالَتْ: لَا عَيْشَ مَعَ فِرَاقِ الْأَحِبَّةِ وَإِذَا فَارَقَ الْأَلِيفُ أَلِيفَهُ فَقَدْ سُلِبَ فُؤَادَهُ، وَحُرِمَ سُرُورَهُ، وَغُشِّيَ بَصَرُهُ،

She said: There is no life in parting from those we love. When a companion parts from his dear one, his heart is stripped from him, his joy is forbidden him, his sight grows dim.

فَلَمْ يَنْتَهِ كَلَامُهُمَا حَتَّى وَافَى الْقَانِصُ، وَوَافَقَ ذَلِكَ فَرَاغَ الْجُرَذِ مِنْ قَطْعِ الشَّرَكِ، فَنَجَا الظَّبْيُ بِنَفْسِهِ، وَطَارَ الْغُرَابُ مُحَلِّقًا وَدَخَلَ الْجُرَذُ بَعْضَ الْأَحْجَارِ وَلَمْ يَبْقَ غَيْرُ السُّلَحْفَاةِ،

They had not finished speaking when the hunter arrived. This coincided with the rat's finishing the cutting of the snare. The gazelle escaped with his own life; the crow flew up high; the rat entered one of the holes; and none remained but the tortoise.

وَدَنَا الصَّيَّادُ فَوَجَدَ حَبَالَتَهُ مُقَطَّعَةً، فَنَظَرَ يَمِينًا وَشِمَالًا فَلَمْ يَجِدْ غَيْرَ السُّلَحْفَاةِ تَدِبُّ، فَأَخَذَهَا وَرَبَطَهَا،

The hunter came up, found his snares cut, looked right and left, and saw nothing but the tortoise crawling. He took her and bound her.

فَلَمْ يَلْبَثِ الْغُرَابُ وَالْجُرَذُ وَالظَّبْيُ أَنِ اجْتَمَعُوا فَنَظَرُوا الْقَانِصَ قَدْ رَبَطَ السُّلَحْفَاةَ فَاشْتَدَّ حُزْنُهُمْ،

Before long the crow, the rat, and the gazelle reassembled and saw that the hunter had bound the tortoise. Their sorrow grew sharp.

وَقَالَ الْجُرَذُ: مَا أَرَانَا نُجَاوِزُ عَقَبَةً مِنَ الْبَلَاءِ إِلَّا صِرْنَا فِي أَشَدَّ مِنْهَا.

The rat said: I see us passing one trouble only to find ourselves in a worse.

وَلَقَدْ صَدَقَ الَّذِي قَالَ: لَا يَزَالُ الْإِنْسَانُ مُسْتَمِرًّا فِي إِقْبَالِهِ مَا لَمْ يَعْثُرْ، فَإِذَا عَثَرَ لَجَّ بِهِ الْعِثَارُ وَإِنْ مَشَى فِي جَدَدِ الْأَرْضِ.

He spoke truly who said: A man keeps rising in his fortune so long as he does not stumble; but when he stumbles, stumbling clings to him, even should he walk on level ground.

وَحَذَرِي عَلَى السُّلَحْفَاةِ خَيْرِ الْأَصْدِقَاءِ الَّتِي خُلَّتُهَا لَيْسَتْ لِلْمُجَازَاةِ وَلَا لِالْتِمَاسِ مُكَافَأَةٍ، وَلَكِنَّهَا خُلَّةُ الْكَرَمِ وَالشَّرَفِ،

My fear is for the tortoise, best of friends, whose affection is not for recompense, not for seeking reward, but the affection of nobility and honour.

خُلَّةٌ هِيَ أَفْضَلُ مِنْ خُلَّةِ الْوَالِدِ لِوَلَدِهِ، خُلَّةٌ لَا يُزِيلُهَا إِلَّا الْمَوْتُ.

An affection finer than a father's for his child — an affection that nothing removes but death.

وَيْحٌ لِهَذَا الْجَسَدِ الْمُوَكَّلِ بِهِ الْبَلَاءُ الَّذِي لَا يَزَالُ فِي تَصَرُّفٍ وَتَقَلُّبٍ، وَلَا يَدُومُ لَهُ شَيْءٌ، وَلَا يَلْبَثُ مَعَهُ أَمْرٌ،

Woe to this body assigned to affliction, ever changing, ever turning; nothing endures for it, nothing lingers with it —

كَمَا لَا يَدُومُ لِلطَّالِعِ مِنَ النُّجُومِ طُلُوعٌ، وَلَا لِلْآفِلِ مِنْهَا أُفُولٌ، لَكِنْ لَا يَزَالُ لِلطَّالِعِ مِنْهَا آفِلًا، وَالْآفِلُ طَالِعًا،

just as the rising of a star does not endure for the rising one, nor its setting for the setting one — but the rising star ever comes to setting, and the setting to rising.

وَكَمَا تَكُونُ آلَامُ الْكُلُومِ وَانْتِقَاضُ الْجِرَاحَاتِ، كَذَلِكَ مَنْ قَرِحَتْ كُلُومُهُ بِفَقْدِ إِخْوَانِهِ بَعْدَ اجْتِمَاعِهِ بِهِمْ.

As the pains of old sores and the reopening of wounds afflict the body, so he whose wounds are torn open by the loss of his brethren after once being gathered with them.

فَقَالَ الظَّبْيُ وَالْغُرَابُ لِلْجُرَذِ: إِنَّ حَذَرَنَا وَحَذَرَكَ وَكَلَامَكَ، وَإِنْ كَانَ بَلِيغًا، كُلٌّ مِنْهَا لَا يُغْنِي عَنِ السُّلَحْفَاةِ شَيْئًا،

The gazelle and the crow said to the rat: Our caution, and yours, and your speech — eloquent as it is — none of these avails the tortoise anything.

وَإِنَّهُ كَمَا يُقَالُ: إِنَّمَا يُخْتَبَرُ النَّاسُ عِنْدَ الْبَلَاءِ، وَذُو الْأَمَانَةِ عِنْدَ الْأَخْذِ وَالْعَطَاءِ، وَالْأَهْلُ وَالْوَلَدُ عِنْدَ الْفَاقَةِ، كَذَلِكَ يُخْتَبَرُ الْإِخْوَانُ عِنْدَ النَّوَائِبِ.

As the saying goes: people are tested by misfortune; the man of trust by receiving and giving; family and child by want; and just so are brethren tested in calamities.

قَالَ الْجُرَذُ: أَرَى مِنَ الْحِيلَةِ أَنْ تَذْهَبَ أَيُّهَا الظَّبْيُ فَتَقَعَ بِمَنْظَرٍ مِنَ الْقَانِصِ كَأَنَّكَ جَرِيحٌ، وَيَقَعَ الْغُرَابُ عَلَيْكَ كَأَنَّهُ يَأْكُلُ مِنْكَ،

The rat said: Here is a stratagem. Go, O gazelle, and appear within the hunter's sight as if you were wounded, and let the crow settle upon you as if he were eating from you.

وَأَسْعَى أَنَا فَأَكُونَ قَرِيبًا مِنَ الْقَانِصِ، مُرَاقِبًا لَهُ، فَعَلَّهُ أَنْ يَرْمِيَ مَا مَعَهُ مِنَ الْآلَةِ، وَيَضَعَ السُّلَحْفَاةَ، وَيَقْصِدَكَ طَامِعًا فِيكَ، رَاجِيًا تَحْصِيلَكَ.

I shall hurry along close to the hunter, keeping watch on him — that he may perhaps throw down the gear he carries, set the tortoise aside, and make for you, greedy for you, hoping to take you.

فَإِذَا دَنَا مِنْكَ فَفِرَّ عَنْهُ رُوَيْدًا بِحَيْثُ لَا يَنْقَطِعُ طَمَعُهُ مِنْكَ، وَمَكِّنْهُ مِنْ أَخْذِكَ مَرَّةً بَعْدَ مَرَّةٍ، حَتَّى يَبْعُدَ عَنَّا، وَانْحُ مِنْهُ هَذَا النَّحْوَ مَا اسْتَطَعْتَ،

When he draws near, slip away slowly — but not so far that his greed for you breaks off. Let him all but take you, again and again, until he is far from us; keep on in this fashion so long as you can.

فَإِنِّي أَرْجُو أَلَّا يَنْصَرِفَ إِلَّا وَقَدْ قَطَعْتُ الْحَبَائِلَ عَنِ السُّلَحْفَاةِ، وَأَنْجُو بِهَا.

I hope that he will not turn back until I have cut the cords from the tortoise and escaped with her.

فَفَعَلَ الْغُرَابُ وَالظَّبْيُ مَا أَمَرَهُمَا بِهِ الْجُرَذُ، وَتَبِعَهُمَا الْقَانِصُ، فَاسْتَجَرَّهُ الظَّبْيُ، حَتَّى أَبْعَدَهُ عَنِ الْجُرَذِ وَالسُّلَحْفَاةِ،

The crow and the gazelle did as the rat had commanded. The hunter followed them; the gazelle drew him on until he had led him far from the rat and the tortoise.

وَالْجُرَذُ مُقْبِلٌ عَلَى قَطْعِ الْحَبَائِلِ، حَتَّى قَطَعَهَا، وَنَجَا بِالسُّلَحْفَاةِ،

The rat was busy cutting the cords until he severed them and escaped with the tortoise.

وَعَادَ الْقَانِصُ مَجْهُودًا لَاغِبًا فَوَجَدَ حَبَالَتَهُ مُقَطَّعَةً.

The hunter came back exhausted and spent, and found his snares cut.

فَفَكَّرَ فِي أَمْرِهِ مَعَ الظَّبْيِ الْمُتَظَالِعِ، فَظَنَّ أَنَّهُ خُولِطَ فِي عَقْلِهِ وَفَكَّرَ فِي أَمْرِ الظَّبْيِ وَالْغُرَابِ الَّذِي كَأَنَّهُ يَأْكُلُ مِنْهُ وَقَرَضَ حَبَالَتَهُ فَاسْتَوْحَشَ مِنَ الْأَرْضِ وَقَالَ: هَذِهِ أَرْضُ جِنٍّ أَوْ سَحَرَةٍ.

He thought over the matter of the limping gazelle and supposed his mind was astray. He thought on the gazelle and the crow seemingly eating from him, and the cutting of his snares — terror of the land seized him, and he said: This is the land of jinn or sorcerers.

فَرَجَعَ مُوَلِّيًا لَا يَلْتَكِسُ شَيْئًا وَلَا يَلْتَفِتُ إِلَيْهِ.

He turned back and fled, neither gathering up anything nor looking behind him.

وَاجْتَمَعَ الْغُرَابُ وَالظَّبْيُ وَالْجُرَذُ وَالسُّلَحْفَاةُ إِلَى عَرِيشِهِمْ سَالِمِينَ آمِنِينَ كَأَحْسَنِ مَا كَانُوا عَلَيْهِ.

The crow, the gazelle, the rat, and the tortoise came back to their bower safe and secure, in the best state they had known.

فَإِذَا كَانَ هَذَا الْخَلْقُ مَعَ صِغَرِهِ وَضَعْفِهِ قَدْ قَدَرَ عَلَى التَّخَلُّصِ مِنْ مَرَابِطِ الْهَلَكَةِ مَرَّةً بَعْدَ أُخْرَى بِمَوَدَّتِهِ وَخُلُوصِهَا وَثَبَاتِ قَلْبِهِ عَلَيْهَا وَاسْتِمْتَاعِهِ مَعَ أَصْحَابِهِ بَعْضِهِمْ بِبَعْضٍ،

If these creatures, despite their smallness and weakness, were able to escape the snares of destruction again and again by their love for one another, its sincerity, the steadfastness of their hearts in it, and their taking delight in each other's company —

then man, to whom intellect and understanding have been given, inspired to good rather than to evil, granted discernment and knowledge, is all the more fit and worthy to cherish fellowship and mutual support.

Such is the parable of the Brethren of Purity, and of their harmony in companionship.

فَالْإِنْسَانُ الَّذِي قَدْ أُعْطِيَ الْعَقْلَ وَالْفَهْمَ. وَأُلْهِمَ الْخَيْرَ وَلَا الشَّرَّ وَمُنِحَ التَّمْيِيزَ وَالْمَعْرِفَةَ، أَوْلَى وَأَحْرَى بِالتَّوَاصُلِ وَالتَّعَاضُدِ.

فَهَذَا مَثَلُ إِخْوَانِ الصَّفَاءِ وَائْتِلَافِهِمْ فِي الصُّحْبَةِ.

3,157 tokens · 432 unfamiliar lemmas · 437 not yet in Alif

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